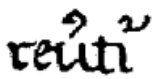
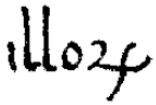
(A) Holy Roman Shorthand (1/3) [10 Points]

Before the printing press was invented, books had to be copied by hand. In Medieval Europe, most of this copying was done by monks. Poor lighting and other factors made this a difficult, often painful, task[1] – so it's no wonder that monks developed an extensive system of abbreviations to speed up their work!

For example, if a monk wanted to write the Latin words *revertitur* and *illorum*, they might have written:

 and 

Below are some examples of abbreviated Latin[2] words you might find in a Medieval manuscript. Note that we've made some formatting changes when typing them up. Next to each one is the full (un-shortened) Latin word it corresponds to. In the right column, one possible English translation of the word is given. The English translations, and knowledge of Latin in general, aren't necessary or helpful to solve this problem.

Abbreviated Latin word	Latin word	English translation
$reu^{9}ti^{2}$	*revertitur*	she returns
$\mathfrak{p}cul$	*procul*	far
su^{9}	*suus*	its own
$\bar{\imath}p^{9}p7\overline{uu}$	*imperpetuum*	not lasting
$illo\mathfrak{z}$	*illorum*	of theirs
(a)	*conversatio*	conversation
(b)	*fortis*	strong
(c)	*complexio*	combination
(d)	*martis*	of Mars
(e)	*caveret*	he might fear
(f)	*introductum*	introduced

A1. On your Answer Sheets, fill in the blanks (a) to (f) with the number (1-6) of the correct abbreviation from the list below:

1. $f^{o}tis$ 2. $\bar{\imath}t^{o}ductū$ 3. $9u^{9}sa^{o}$ 4. $9p^{x}io$ 5. $cau^{9}7$ 6. $m^{a}tis$

<u>Make sure you record your answers in your Answer Sheets!</u>

1. A quote from the 10th century about manuscript copying reads: "It dims your eyes, makes your back ache, and knits your chest and belly together. It is a terrible ordeal for the whole body."
2. Latin was the language of ancient Rome. In Medieval Europe, Latin continued to be used in many contexts, such as in religious and scholarly settings.

(A) Holy Roman Shorthand (2/3)

A2. There can be many ways to abbreviate a Latin word. Below are 5 abbreviated words. 4 of them stand for the same Latin word. On your Answer Sheet, write the letter of the one that does not match the others.

a. *9probatum* **b.** *cōprobatū* **c.** *comp^{o}batum* **d.** *9probat^{9}* **e.** *9probatū*

In English, we sometimes use the symbol & as an abbreviation for *and.* This symbol originally comes from the Latin word *et*, meaning "and". In some fonts, the way that this symbol is written makes it easier to see how it came from the letter *e* plus the letter *t.* Here is one example:

A3. Some monks used the symbol & in their writing in the same contexts where one of the symbols listed below might be used. Which one? Write the correct letter on your Answer Sheet.

a. *7* **b.** *9* **c.** *ī* **d.** *ō* **e.** *ū*

A4. On your Answer Sheets, give abbreviated forms for the Latin words in the table on the next page, labeled (a) through (f). You should write your abbreviations using the numerical codes shown in the symbol bank at the bottom of the next page, writing one number from 1 to 22 in each box on your Answer Sheet. *Notes:*

- Some symbols appear multiple times in the symbol bank, always with the same number. You should use a given symbol no more times than it appears in the symbol bank. For example, there are four copies of *n* (number 9), so you should not use the number 9 more than four times in your answers.
- As **A2** showed, there can be more than one way to abbreviate a Latin word. However, for this question (**A4**), there is only one correct abbreviation for each Latin word, because other ways of abbreviating would not satisfy the constraints imposed by the symbol bank.
- Some symbols will be left over in the symbol bank after you complete **A4**—see **A5** for more details.
- There are more boxes on your Answer Sheets than you need; it's okay to leave some blank boxes at the end of an answer.

For example, if you think the answer to (a) is *d^{9}*, your answer would look like the boxes below, with 3 standing for *d*, 22 standing for *^{9}*, and six blank boxes left over:

3	**22**						

Make sure you record your answers in your Answer Sheets!

(A) Holy Roman Shorthand (3/3)

<u>This table and the symbol bank below it are for problem A4, which is described on the previous page.</u>

	Latin word	English translation
(a)	*procatis*	you (plural) ask
(b)	*notarum*	of the known ones
(c)	*decernimus*	we decide
(d)	*congnitio*	knowledge [alternate form of *cognitio*]
(e)	*crux*	cross
(f)	*petitur*	it is sought for

SYMBOL BANK

a	*a*	*a*	*c*	*c*	*c*	*c*	*d*	*d*	*e*	*e*	*g*	*i*	*i*	*i*			
1	1	1	2	2	2	2	3	3	4	4	5	6	6	6			
ī	*l*	*n*	*n*	*n*	*n*	*o*	*o*	*p*	*s*								
7	8	9	9	9	9	10	11	12	13								
t	*t*	*u*	*x*	*p*	*2*	*2*	*7*	*9*	*9*	*9*							
14	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	22							

A5. If you have completed **A4** correctly, there should be six numbers left over in the symbol bank. The symbols corresponding to these numbers can be arranged into an English word that could be a good birthday gift for a Medieval monk. What is the English word? Write it on your Answer Sheet.

<u>Make sure you record your answers in your Answer Sheets!</u>